

Q: Who was the Abu Bakr (RA)? Point out the significant contributions of Khadifah Abu Bakr. as the savior of Islam?

Answer:

Hazrat Abu Bakr RA was the closest companion, father-in-law, and the foremost supporter of Prophet Muhammad. His real name was Abdullah Ibn Abi Quhafa.

He was given the title of "As-Siddiq" by Prophet because he was the first to believe in the event of Isra and Mi'raj without any hesitation.

→ He was the first adult free male to accept Islam.

→ He accompanied the Prophet during the perilous Hijrah to Madinah.

→ After death of Prophet in 632 CE, he was selected as the first Caliph of the Islamic State.

## \* Significant Contribution of Abu Bakr RA. as the "Savior of Islam":—

According to K. Ali, Abu Bakr's firm and unwavering faith earned him the title "The Savior of Islam".

His major contributions are:—

### 1. Dispatching the Army of Usama (RA):—

Before his death, the Prophet had organized an army under Usama (RA) to fight the Romans. Despite the outbreak of rebellions in Arabia and advice from Umar (RA) to keep the army in Madinah for defense, Abu Bakr (RA) firmly refused to alter the Prophet's last command. It showed them that Muslims were still strong.

### 2. Suppressing the Apostasy Movement:—

Many Arabian tribes renounced Islam, believing their allegiance ended with the Prophet's death. Abu Bakr divided the Muslim army into 11 battalions under

capable commanders like Khalid bin Walid, successfully crushed the apostate rebellions, reuniting the Arabian <sup>ख़दीरा</sup> Peninsula under Islam.

### 3. Uncompromising Stance on Zakat:-

Several tribes remained Muslims but refused to pay the Zakat, treating it as a personal tribute to the prophet. Abu Bakr stood firm like a rock and declared: "By Allah! If they withhold even a tying cord which they used to give to the Messenger of Allah, I will fight them for it."

### 4. Crushing the false Prophet:

Four major imposters claimed prophethood: Musaylimah the liar, Aswad Ansi, Tulayha and Sajah). Abu Bakr sent Khalid bin Walid, who decisively defeated Musaylimah in the fierce Battle of Yamamah, ending the threat of false prophets.

### ⑤ Compilation of the Holy Quran:-

During the Battle of Yamamah, hundreds of Huffaz were martyred. Realizing the danger of losing the divine text, Umar (RA) suggested compiling the Quran into a single book. Abu Bakr initially hesitated but then agreed. He ordered Zaid Bin Thabit to collect the Quran into one unified written manuscript.

### ⑥ Securing the Frontiers:-

To secure the borders of the Islamic State from the Persian and Roman empires, he initiated military campaigns. Khalid bin Walid achieved brilliant victories in Iraq and Syria.

Conclusion: Abu Bakr ruled for 2 years 3 months, but his achievements were monumental. Had he shown weakness, Islam might have vanished into the deserts of Arabia.

Ques:- Administrative development during the Khulafa-e-Rashidin period. --

Answer:

① Majlis-e-Shura:

The administration was entirely democratic in nature. The Caliph was the supreme head of the state. He ran administration with the consultation of Majlis-e-Shura, comprising prominent and wise companions. The Caliph was fully accountable to the people.

② Provincial Administration :-

Due to rapid expansion, Caliph Umar RA. divided the vast Islamic empire into several provinces (Syria, Egypt, Basra, Kufa) for administrative convenience. Each province was placed under a Governor known as the Wali. The Wali was assisted by

other officials like Amil (Revenue Collector), and Police Chief.

## 2. Revenue System and Bait-ul-Mal: —

A permanent public treasury known as the Bait-ul-Mal was firmly established. Primary sources of revenue: —

① Zakat: Poor due collected from rich Muslims.

② Jizya: A nominal protection tax paid by non-Muslim citizens, in lieu of military service.

③ Kharaj: Land tax collected from non-Muslims.

④ Khums: One-fifth of the spoils of war.

⑤ Ushr: Tax on agricultural produce and trade duties.

Bait-ul-Mal was used for state expenses, public welfare, a well-organized pension system (Diwan)

## ④ Independent Judiciary: —

The administration of justice was completely impartial.

The Khulafa-e-Rashidin was separated from the judiciary from the executive branch. Judges were appointed the Caliph based on their deep knowledge of Islamic law and unquestionable integrity.

### ⑤ Military and Police Departments:—

Caliph Umar (RA) established a regular standing army and set up military camps in places like Basra, Kufa and Fustat. Soldiers were paid regular salaries from the state treasury.

A regular police force was introduced to maintain internal law and order and prisons were established for the first time in Islamic history.

Q:- Development of the Shurah (Consultative System) in Islam.

Answer:-

The concept of Shurah is the cornerstone of the Islamic Political and administrative system. Its development can be traced from the Quranic injunctions to its institutionalization during the period of the Khulafa-e-Rashidun.

① Quranic Foundation:

The concept of Shura is not a human invention, but a divine command. Allah says, "and consult them in the matter." — Surah Al'Imran. Furthermore, an entire chapter in the Quran named Ash-Shura, where Allah praises the believers whose "and whose affair are decided by mutual consultation."

2. Practical Foundation by the Prophet (PBUH):-

Prophet (PBUH) laid the practical groundwork for the Shurah. Even though he received direct divine revelation he consulted his companions on secular military,

and state matters to set an example for future generations. Like, he consulted them on the treatment of prisoners after the Battle of Badr, accepted Salman Al-Farsi's advice to dig a trench in the Battle of Khandaq.

### 3. Application during <sup>the era of</sup> Abu-Bakr (R):-

After the Prophet's demise, Abu Bakr made the Shurah the operational basis of the Caliphate. Whenever a complex issue arose that was not explicitly solved by the Quran/Shurah, he summoned senior companions for consultation. Decisions on fighting the Ridda War were made through this consultative process.

### 4. Institutionalization by Caliph Umar (R):-

The Shurah system saw its formal institutionalization during the reign of Umar (RA). To manage a rapidly

expanding empire, he categorized the Shurah into two bodies:-

① Majlis-e-Khas:- This consisted of highly knowledgeable and elite companions who were consulted on a daily basis for urgent state affairs and administrative matters.

② Majlis-e-Aam:- This was convened for national crisis matters or critical importance. Ordinary citizens, provincial representatives, and even non-Muslim were allowed to express their opinions freely.

③ Historic Example of Shurah in Action:-

① Land of Sawad (Iraq) When generals urged the distribution of conquered agricultural lands in Iraq among soldiers, Umar (R) consulted the Shurah. Following days of debate, the council agreed to

retain the land as state property, charging a land tax.

① Public Criticism: When Umar R proposed setting a maximum ~~&~~ Mahr, an unnamed woman challenged him using Surah An-Nisa. Umar publicly ~~retract~~ retracted his proposal, declaring, "The woman is right and Umar is wrong."

Q: Explain the origin and development of the institution of Khalifah in Islam. What are the qualities and responsibilities of a Khalifah? + including election system.

Ans:

The word Khalifah literally means "succession". In the Islamic political and religious context, it refers to the system of the Govt. where the head of the state is the Khalifah, who acts as the successor to Prophet Mohammad (PBUH). He succeeds Prophet (PBUH) only in political

administrative and military leadership, not in Prophethood.

### \* Origin of the Khilafah:-

Muhammad (PBUH) died in 632 CE, he did not nominate a successor. Upon his death, a crisis arose between the Ansar and the Muhajirin regarding who would lead the Muslim community. Through the timely intervention of Umar and Abu Ubaidah (R) at Saqifah Bani Sa'idah, Abu Bakr (R) was selected as the Caliph taking the title of Khalifat Rasul Allah, thus originating the institution of the Caliphate based on the democratic principle of consensus.

### \* Development of the Khilafah:-

#### ① The Pious Caliphate (632-661 CE):

The era of the Khulafa-e-Rashidun. The state was a pure republic. This era represented the golden model

of "Theo-Democracy," where rulers were chosen by public consent, shurah and maintained extreme simplicity and accountability.

### ② The Umayyad Caliphate: (661-750 CE):

Founded by Mu'awiyah. The transition marked a shift from elective consultation to hereditary monarchy. Damascus became the capital and lifestyle of Caliphs became imperial and luxurious.

### ② The Abbasid Caliphate (750-1258 CE):

The capital shifted to Baghdad. The Caliphs eventually become mere figureheads under the control of powerful military commanders. (the Seljuks). The institution collapsed with the Mongol sack in 1258

### ④ The Ottoman Caliphate (1281-1924 CE):-

Centered in Istanbul, it united much of the

the Islamic world for centuries until its official abolition by Mustafa Kamal Atatürk in March 1924.

### Qualities of a Khalifa:

- ① Personal Traits: Must be an adult, male, sane and a practicing Muslim.
- ② Knowledge: Must possess deep knowledge of the Quran, Hadith, Islamic Law.
- ③ Justice: Must be highly just, impartial and free from corruption.
- ④ Physical and mental faculties:-  
Sound judgement, hearing, sight, and free from physical limitation.
- ⑤ Courage and vision:  
Must possess political acumen, administrative capability and bravery to defend the state.

### Responsibilities of a Khalifah:

- ① To lead the five daily prayers and Friday congregations.

(ii) To protect the country from external enemies and defend its borders.

(iii) To establish strict justice and implement the Islamic punishment system to prevent crimes.

(iv) To maintain strict law and order to make the country completely safe and secure.

(v) To systematically collect Zakat and other revenue.

(vi) To pay the salaries of govt. officials, staff and soldiers on-time.

### ④ Election System:

① Direct Election: Abu Bakr was selected through open discussion and consensus.

② Nomination: Abu Bakr (RA) nominated Umar (RA) on his deathbed after consulting leading companions.

(iii) Shurah: Umar (RA) appointed a council of six eminent companions to elect next Caliph among themselves, resulting the election of Hazrat Uthman (RA).

(iv) Public Demand: Hazrat Ali was pressed into accepting the Khilafah in Medinah after assassination of Uthman (RA).